Name: .....

ID: .....

Section No. _____

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
EL117
Academic Writing
All Branches
Final Exam

2024-2025 /Fall
Date: 14 Jan. 2025
9:30 – 11:30

Number of Exam Pages: 10 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer ALL the sections.
2. In section 1, apply the learned skills for writing focus by answering few analytical questions related to unity, cohesion, structure, and mechanics of writing.
3. In section 2, choose only one topic and outline a five-paragraph essay.
4. In section 3, write a standard essay: start with an introduction, develop well-written body paragraphs, end with a concluding paragraph. After you finish writing your essay, edit and proofread it paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. Devote 5 minutes for reading through the whole paper and making the appropriate selection of questi

Grades:

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's Init Signatu
ection I: Writing Focus & Editing	40	20		
ection II: Essay Outlining	20	5		
ection III: Essay Writing	60	25		
Total in Figures		50		
Total in Letters	120 Minutes	Fifty Marks		

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Section	1	Writing Focus & Editing	20 POINTS	40 MINUTES

I. Choose the right answer from a, b, c or d. *(1 point each)*

1. Which of the following is a key feature of a compare and contrast essay?

a. Explaining a process step by step.
b. Presenting similarities and differences between two or more subjects.
c. Describing a single topic in detail.
d. Arguing for or against a particular position.

2. Which of the following transitions is most appropriate for a compare and contrast essay?

a. "First, then, finally"
b. "On the other hand"
c. "Therefore"
d. "For example"

3. When writing the conclusion of a compare and contrast essay, what is important to include?

a. A detailed summary of all the similarities and differences.
b. New information that was not discussed in the body paragraphs.
c. A restatement of the thesis and the significance of the comparison.
d. A list of possible future research topics.

4. What is the potential advantage of using the point-by-point comparison pattern?

a. It allows for a more comprehensive analysis of each subject separately.
b. It prevents the writer from having to repeat information about each subject.
c. It makes it easier for the reader to see the direct comparisons and contrasts between the subjects.
d. It allows for a stronger focus on one subject rather than balancing both.

5. Which of the following topics would be most appropriate for a point-by-point comparison pattern?

a. The history of the Roman Empire and the history of Ancient Greece.
b. The features of electric cars and the features of hybrid cars.
c. A chronological account of World War I events.
d. A step-by-step guide to baking a cake.

6. What is the most common organizational structure for a compare and contrast essay?

a. Point-by-point
b. Block-by-block
c. Chronological
d. Cause and effect

ACCEPT

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7. What is the purpose of addressing counterarguments in an argumentative essay?

a. To weaken your own argument
b. To show that your argument is more valid
c. To avoid criticism
d. To make the essay longer

8. In persuasive writing, which of the following techniques is most effective for appealing to an audience's emotions?

a. Using factual statistics
b. Sharing personal stories or anecdotes
c. Including expert testimony
d. Listing potential counterarguments

9 When considering the tone of a persuasive essay, which approach is most suitable?

a. Formal and unbiased
b. Casual and conversational
c. Aggressive and confrontational
d. Confident and convincing.

10. Which logical mistake should be avoided in an argumentative essay?

a. Using credible evidence
b. Presenting multiple viewpoints
c. Attacking the person instead of the argument (ad hominem)
d. Using statistics to support the claim

11. Which of the following statements is an example of a counterargument in an argumentative essay about banning plastic straws?

a. "Plastic straws are a significant contributor to ocean pollution."
b. "Many businesses are already switching to paper straws."
c. "Banning plastic straws will not significantly reduce ocean pollution, as straws make up only a small percentage of plastic waste."
d. "Consumers need to be more aware of the environmental impact of their choices."

12. Which statement represents a counterargument to the position that students should have shorter school days?

a. "Shorter school days could allow students more time for extracurricular activities."
b. "Some argue that reducing school hours would negatively impact students' learning outcomes due to less instructional time."
c. "Teachers could use the extra time for planning and professional development."
d. "Several countries with shorter school days still perform well academically."

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13. Which of the following sentences is grammatically correct?

a. Neither the manager nor the employees was able to solve the issue.
b. The list of topics are on the professor's desk.
c. Both the cat and the dog sleeps on the couch.
d. The data collected from the surveys were analyzed thoroughly.

14. Which sentence demonstrates correct subject-verb agreement?

a. The books on the shelf needs to be organized.
b. The team of scientists are presenting their findings today.
c. The teacher, along with her students, is attending the workshop.
d. The dogs in the park chases after the ball.

15. Which sentence demonstrates correct parallel structure?

a. She spent her weekend cleaning the house, baking cookies, and to garden.
b. He enjoys listening to music, watching TV, and playing sports.
c. They are responsible for answering customer calls, filing paperwork, and to schedule appointments.
d. The teacher asked the students to write essays, complete worksheets, and reading chapters from the book.

II. Evaluate each of the following thesis statements as Correct or Incorrect.

(1 point ea

1. "Online education provides flexible learning opportunities for students who cannot att traditional classes due to time or location constraints."

_____

2. "School uniforms are good because everyone looks the same."

_____

3. "Implementing stricter gun control laws can help reduce gun violence and increase pu safety."

_____

4. "Watching TV is bad for you."

_____

5. "Social media can negatively impact mental health by contributing to feelings of isolation, anxiety, and depression."

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Section	2	Outlining	5 POINTS	20 MINUTES

Outline ONE of the following topics by filling in the graphic organizer below. ***(5 points)***

1. While some argue that school uniforms can promote discipline, they can also suppress students' individuality and self-expression. Mandatory uniforms may create a sense of conformity that discourages creativity. Should school uniforms be mandatory. Provide logical arguments and examples.

2. Analyse the similarities and differences between print media and digital media in shaping public opinion. How do their methods of information delivery, audience engagement, and influence on public discourse compare. Use specific examples and evidence to support your analysis. Give detailed explanation following point-by-point comparison.

Introductory Paragraph: ***(1 point)***

Hook/Opening statement:

_____

_____

Thesis statement:

_____

_____

Body Paragraph (1): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (1):

_____

_____

Major supporting details:

_____

_____

_____

_____

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Body Paragraph (2): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (2):

Major supporting details:

Body Paragraph (3): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (3):

Major supporting details:

Concluding Paragraph: ***(1 point)***

Restatement of the thesis:

Final comment:

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Tutor's remarks on language and content:

Marking Rubric

The introductory paragraph should: • capture the reader's attention • provide background knowledge • include a clear thesis statement stating what the body paragraphs describe (controlling idea and predictors)	3 points
Each body paragraph: • describes one aspect of the topic • begins with a topic sentence that develops one main idea • has some major and minor supporting sentences that give more information about the topic sentence by explaining it with supporting details (facts, examples, experience/anecdote, and/or description • has a concluding sentence to close the paragraph	9 points
All paragraphs should have coherence, cohesion and unity as follows: • use of proper order, • use of cohesive devices, • use of relevant sentences, • use of reference words, and • repetition of keywords.	3 points
All paragraphs have been edited for grammar as follows: • it demonstrates control of basic grammar (e.g. tenses, verb forms, noun forms, prepositions, articles, etc.) • it shows sophistication of sentence structure with complex and compound sentences.	3 points
All paragraphs have been edited for mechanics: • it demonstrates good control over use of capital letters, periods, commas, semicolons and spelling • it does not have fragments, comma splices, and/or run-on sentences	2 points
The concluding paragraph should: • restate the thesis • summarizes the main points • uses concluding statements to signal the end of the essay (final comment) • have coherence, cohesion and unity • use appropriate grammar and mechanics	5 points

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